

that's only true 59% of the time, so allow variations. Do not discard a pattern because it has an unusual volume trend.

Table 30.5 Size Statistics

Description	Down Breakout
Tall pattern performance	−18%
Short pattern performance	−13%
Median height as a percentage of breakout price	7.1%
Narrow pattern performance	−14%
Wide pattern performance	−16%
Median width	15 days
Short and narrow performance	−13%
Short and wide performance	−13%
Tall and wide performance	−17%
Tall and narrow performance	−18%

Rising/Falling volume. Double tops with rising volume performed slightly better than did those with falling bottoms, but not so you'd want to stand on the rooftops and yell, “Eureka!”

Breakout day volume. Many traders will swear that heavy breakout volume adds to the reliability of a pattern. Some technicians demand it. But have they proved it?

The table shows what I found, and it's a yawn. Heavy breakout volume *does* help, but only by two percentage points and that's if you trade it perfectly and often enough (over a thousand times).

Table 30.7 shows how often price reaches a stop location. I split the pattern in half but used anesthetic. I found, for example, that a stop placed at the top of the pattern triggered 3% of the time. However, if you were shorting the stock, the stop might be too far away to be tolerable. Perhaps you'd like something closer. If so, the table shows the hit rate for two other locations.

Table 30.8 shows the performance over three decades.